

To implement a granular, graphically configurable Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) system that maintains synchronization between code and storage, a rigorous architecture is required.

Here is the most robust approach to achieve flexibility and Front/Back-end consistency.

## 1. Database Modeling (The Foundation)

To allow for graphical management, permissions must not be "hardcoded" solely in the code but must persist in the database.

The standard relational model should include 5 entities:

1. **Users:** The actual users.
2. **Roles:** Logical groups (e.g., Admin, Editor, Guest).
3. **Permissions:** Atomic functionalities (e.g., user.create, invoice.read).
4. **Role\_Permissions:** Linking table (Which role has which permission).
5. **User\_Roles:** Linking table (Which user has which role).

**Key Point:** The Permissions table is the source of truth for your graphical interface.

## 2. Naming and "Discovery" (Handling Updates)

This is where maintainability is determined when adding features. If you add a function in the code, it must automatically appear in the administration interface.

### A. Naming Convention

Adopt a strict hierarchical structure using strings (Scoping).

Format: resource:action or module:resource:action.

- users:read
- users:write
- reports:export\_pdf

### B. Synchronization (Code First)

Never create permissions manually via SQL. Permissions should be defined in the code (Back-end) via decorators or constants, and then synchronized.

### Synchronization Algorithm (at API startup):

1. Scan the code to find all routes/functions protected by a permission.

2. Extract the unique list of permissions (e.g., ['users:read', 'users:write']).
3. **Upsert** into the database:
  - If the permission does not exist in DB  $\rightarrow$  Create the entry (so it appears in the UI).
  - If the permission exists in DB but is no longer in the code  $\rightarrow$  Mark as "obsolete" or delete (with caution).

**Benefit:** As soon as you deploy a new version of the code with a new feature, the permission automatically appears in your role management interface.

### 3. Back-End Implementation (Security)

The Back-end should not concern itself with roles, but **only with permissions**.

- **Middleware / Guard:** Intercepts every request.
- **Logic:**
  1. Retrieve the current user.
  2. Load their roles  $\rightarrow$  Load permissions associated with those roles.
  3. Flatten everything into an array of strings: ['users:read', 'products:write'].
  4. Check if the permission required by the endpoint (e.g., users:read) is present in this array.

#### Conceptual Example (Pseudo-code):

TypeScript

// Definition in the controller

```
@RequirePermission('invoices:validate')
```

```
function validateInvoice(id) { ... }
```

// In the Guard (Interceptor)

```
function canActivate(user, requiredPermission) {
```

```
  const userPermissions = db.getPermissionsForUser(user.id);
```

```
  return userPermissions.includes(requiredPermission);
```

}

#### 4. Front-End Implementation (UX and Consistency)

The Front-end must receive the user's list of permissions immediately upon login (or via a /me endpoint).

- **Structural Directive (Vue/Angular/React):** Create a component or directive that conditions DOM rendering.
  - *Example:* `<ShowIf permission="users:create"><Button>Add</Button></ShowIf>`
- **Route Guards:** Prevent navigation to a URL if the permission is missing.

**Important:** Front-end hiding is only cosmetic. Real security is ensured by rejecting the request on the Back-end (point 3).

#### 5. The Graphical Management Interface (Configuration)

To make this graphically configurable, the ideal interface is a **Permission Matrix**.

**How the Admin Screen works:**

1. **Columns:** Display existing Roles (retrieved from the Roles table).
2. **Rows:** Display existing Permissions (retrieved from the Permissions table, populated by your sync script).
3. **Cells:** Checkboxes. Checking a box creates an entry in the Role\_Permissions table.

Visual Grouping:

To avoid an indigestible list of 200 permissions, use the prefix from your naming convention (users:, invoices:) to create accordion sections in your table (e.g., "User Management" Section, "Billing" Section).

#### Technical Architecture Summary

| Layer       | Responsibility | Action                                                                |
|-------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Code (Back) | Definition     | Declares product:delete via annotation on an API route.               |
| Sync Script | Discovery      | Scans code at startup, inserts product:delete into Permissions table. |

| Layer                      | Responsibility | Action                                                                                |
|----------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Admin UI</b>            | Configuration  | Displays product:delete. Admin checks the box for the "Manager" role.                 |
| <b>Database</b>            | Storage        | Saves the association Role: Manager $\longleftrightarrow$ Permission: product:delete. |
| <b>Runtime<br/>(Back)</b>  | Security       | Rejects the DELETE request if the user does not have the "Manager" role.              |
| <b>Runtime<br/>(Front)</b> | Display        | Hides the "Delete" button if the user lacks the permission.                           |